

Hadrian's Villa

Location Tivoli, Italy

Roman opulence is nowhere more obvious than at the vast villa built by the Emperor Hadrian in Tivoli, east of Rome, in the 2nd century CE. The entire complex, including the villa, covered an area twice the size of Pompeii (see p.325). Today, only fragments remain of what was once a dazzling array of formal and informal buildings, with sprawling gardens, lakes, pools, fountains, and myriad statues—all heavily inspired by ancient Greece. There is little of the rigid formality associated with the great buildings of Rome. Instead, the villa incorporates a mixture of different styles, features, and innovations.

Hadrian's Mausoleum

Location Rome, Italy

Hadrian's Mausoleum, which from 590 CE has been known as the Castel Sant'Angelo, illustrates the changing fate of many buildings that survived the fall of Rome in the 5th century. It was built by Hadrian, who also built the bridge over the Tiber that leads to it, as a mausoleum for him and his family. It was

completed in 139 CE, the year after his death. In 401, it became a fortress; in 1277, it was taken over by the Vatican, and it became a museum in 1901.

The mausoleum is an immense, circular concrete structure—203 ft (62 m) in diameter and 68 ft (21 m) high—but its exterior was originally clad in marble.

Roman Baths, Aquae Sulis

Location Bath, England

The Romans built public baths in almost every part of their empire. At Bath (Aquae Sulis to the Romans), they had the additional advantage of natural hot-water springs, eliminating the need for the type of heating normally required for the *caldarium* and *tepidarium*, the hot and warm baths. As elsewhere, the role of such baths was as much social as hygienic—a focal point of Roman public life. The centerpiece, then and now, is the Great Bath, with its distinctive green-gray water. It was built from about 70–80 CE and successively rebuilt and enlarged. Originally vaulted, today it lies open to the sky. The stern colonnade that surrounds it would once have been filled with statues.



▲ COLONNADE SURROUNDING THE WATERS OF THE GREAT BATH AT AQUAE SULIS

Baths of Diocletian

Location Rome, Italy

The imperial baths of Rome were among the city's greatest splendors. The most opulent—those of Emperor Diocletian—were the last to be built, completed in about 306 CE. Covering 1.3–1.5 million square ft (120,000–140,000 square m), the baths consisted of a series of vast marbled interiors housing hot rooms, cool rooms, sweating rooms, and plunge pools, made possible by a system of heating—worked by an army of slaves—as elaborate as the aqueducts that delivered water to the city. A magnificent part of the otherwise ruined building was recreated by Michelangelo as the Church of Santa Maria degli Angeli in 1563–1564.

Basilica of Constantine

Location Rome, Italy

Even for Imperial Rome, the Basilica of Constantine, or Basilica Nova, was overwhelming in its size and richness. Today, all that remains are the immense concrete barrel vaults of one of the aisles. The rest of the building—stripped of its treasures—was destroyed by earthquakes in the 9th and 14th centuries. The basilica was built between 307 and 312 CE to house a variety of administrative functions. Its plan was comparatively simple. A groin-vaulted nave—265 ft (80 m) long, 83 ft (25 m) wide, and 115 ft (35 m) high—was flanked by slightly smaller, barrel-vaulted aisles. At one end, an apse housed a similarly oversized statue of Emperor Constantine. Because they were not traditionally associated with Roman temple designs, basilicas of this type were adopted for most Roman Christian churches.

Arch of Constantine

Location Rome, Italy

The triumphal arch, built to commemorate military victories, remains the most immediately distinctive form of Roman public monument. Such arches sprouted across the empire, and in Rome alone, there were more than 50. The Arch of Constantine, built between

